

Reading Strategy

Reading strategies are techniques and approaches used to enhance one's reading comprehension and effectiveness. They help readers better understand and engage with the material they are reading. Here are some common reading strategies:

- **Skimming**: Skimming is a rapid reading technique used to get a general idea of the content. You quickly glance through the text to identify the main topics, headings, and key points. This strategy is useful for previewing a text before reading it in detail.

For example, when deciding whether to read a news article, you might skim the headline and the first few sentences to determine if it's of interest.

- **Scanning**: Scanning involves searching for specific information within a text. Instead of reading every word, you move your eyes quickly over the text, looking for keywords, dates, or names.

For instance, when searching for a particular statistic in a research report, you would scan the document to locate that specific data point.

- **Intensive Reading**: Intensive reading is a detailed and thorough approach where you read every word and sentence carefully. This strategy is typically employed when studying academic texts or analyzing complex literature.

When studying a scientific paper, you would use intensive reading to understand each section deeply.

- **Extensive Reading**: Extensive reading involves quickly reading a large quantity of material to build overall comprehension. This is commonly used for pleasure reading or to gather a broad understanding of a topic.

Reading a novel for leisure or reviewing multiple news articles to get a sense of current events are examples of extensive reading.

- **Previewing**: Previewing is the act of looking over a text briefly to gain an initial understanding of its content and structure. It includes skimming for headings, subheadings, and the introduction.

When beginning to study a textbook, you might preview the chapters, table of contents, and headings to know what to expect.

- **Inference**: Inference is the process of drawing conclusions or making educated guesses based on available evidence in the text.

When you encounter a character's actions in a novel, but their emotions aren't explicitly stated, you might infer how the character feels based on their behavior.

- **Synthesizing**: Synthesizing is the act of integrating information from various sources or parts of a text to create a comprehensive understanding.

For example, you would synthesize information from multiple studies to form a cohesive argument when writing a research paper.

Each of these reading strategies serves a specific purpose and can be applied depending on the type of text and your reading goals.